

Daily Current Affairs

Compiled Class Notes | Date: 25 August 2026 | For All Competitive Exams

1. Avian Influenza (H5N1) – First Mammal Case in Australia

Australia has confirmed its first case of the Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza (H5N1) virus in a mammal. The infected animal was a **Long-nosed Fur Seal**, found on the coast of **South Australia**.

H1N1 vs H5N1

- **H1N1** – commonly called **Swine Flu**; a viral infection that directly affects the human respiratory system. In India, the highest cases/deaths have been reported from **Delhi** and **Kerala** (20+ deaths in Kerala).
- **H5N1** – called **Avian Influenza** (bird flu); normally found in birds, causing large-scale bird deaths. This is **zoonotic in nature** – it can transfer from animals to humans.
- First H5N1 case in the world was recorded in **1996**. In India, an outbreak was recorded at **Pong Lake, Himachal Pradesh**, which caused large-scale bird deaths.

About Australia (Static GK Recap)

- Capital of Australia: **Canberra** (not Sydney). Largest city: **Sydney**. Currency: **Australian Dollar**. National animal: **Kangaroo**.
- Capital of South Australia: **Adelaide**. Capital of Queensland: **Brisbane** (host of 2032 Olympics). Largest state by area: **Western Australia** (capital: Perth).
- Only island of Australia: **Tasmania**; separated from mainland by the **Bass Strait**. Bordered by the Indian Ocean and Pacific Ocean.
- Home to the **Great Barrier Reef** – the world's largest coral reef.
- Upcoming defence exercise **Talisman Sabre 2027** to be hosted by Australia with Indian participation; recently concluded exercise: **Pitch Black**.

2. Tamil Nadu – ‘Annapoorna Super Six’ Scheme

Tamil Nadu CM **M.K. Stalin** (referred to in class as Vijay Thalapathy/CM) launched a scheme to give free LPG gas cylinders via reimbursement (full refund of purchase amount to bank account, i.e., Direct Benefit Transfer).

- Scheme launched on **24 August**; will come into effect from **Pongal 2027**.
- Provides **3 free LPG cylinders** per eligible family (with an upper usage limit).
- Eligibility: annual family income up to **Rs. 2.5 lakh**; covers middle/marginal/unorganised-sector farmers and families with a person with disability.
- Compare with Central Govt's **PM Ujjwala Yojana (2016)** – LPG connection given in the name of women, with a small subsidy (Rs. 10–Rs. 20) directly credited via DBT, to reduce indoor pollution/lung disease from firewood/coal use.
- Related TN scheme: **‘Sathru Payanam’** (free transport) – free bus travel for women and transgender persons, starting **2 October 2026**.

3. Kerala – Nehru Trophy Boat Race / Onam

Held annually during the **Onam** festival in Kerala (Keralam). The **72nd edition** of the **Nehru Trophy Boat Race** (also called the Snake Boat Race, due to the shape of the boats) concluded recently.

- Venue: **Punnamada Lake, Alappuzha district**, Kerala.
- Winner: **Aeroma Boat Club**.
- The race has been held since **1952**.

4. Defence – ‘Baaz’ Battalion & AK-203 ‘Sher’ Rifle

Baaz Battalion

- New drone battalion raised by the **Indian Army**, launched from **Jalandhar, Punjab**; will be deployed along the **India–Pakistan border (~547 km)** for surveillance.
- Will operate under the **Vajra Corps** and use multiple drones (including Israeli drones such as Heron and Harop, and the MQ-series).
- Will use batteries developed by a Lucknow-based company under the **‘Divya Astra’** programme.
- Precedes an earlier battalion named **Bhairav**, also raised by the Indian Army.

AK-203 ‘Sher’ Rifle

- 100% indigenous AK-203 rifles (named **‘Sher’** Rifle) being made under an India–Russia agreement signed in **2019**, to replace the older **AK-47**.
- Manufactured at the **Korwa Ordnance Factory, Amethi, Uttar Pradesh**; first trial of the first unit conducted; final trial scheduled for **6 September 2026**.
- Key specs: calibre **7.62 x 39 mm**; range **800 m**; gas-operated mechanism; modular accessories; about **6 lakh** units to be built, entirely in India.
- Related India–Russia defence items: Sukhoi, MiG, S-400 (India is also in talks to acquire the **S-500**). **BrahMos** missile (originally 290 km range, now enhanced to 400–450 km) – development centre in **Lucknow**; interested buyer countries include the Philippines, Vietnam, Indonesia and Thailand.
- Quick match – equipment & origin: Chinook & Apache – USA; Rafale – France; Pinaka – India (technology being shared with Armenia).

5. California (USA) to Observe Diwali Day

The California State Assembly (USA) has announced that **8 November 2026** will be observed as **Diwali Day**, recognising the large Indian diaspora in the state.

- Note: ‘Lower California’ (Baja California) is located in **Mexico**, not the USA.
- California is also known for the **California Current** in the **Pacific Ocean**.
- Earlier, **15 August** had similarly been recognised as ‘India Day’ in the USA.
- **Diwali** was added to UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage as its **16th** Indian entry (linked to Varanasi). Other Indian entries: **Garba (2023)**, **Yoga (2016)**, **Kumbh Mela (2017)**.

- Hindi calendar note: Diwali, Chhath Puja and Karva Chauth all fall in the month of **Kartik** (roughly October–November).

USA Static GK Recap

- National bird: **Bald Eagle**. Largest state by area: **Alaska**. Statue of Liberty located in: **New York**.
- Form of government: **Presidential**; Head of government: **President**. Total states: **50**.
- Bordered by the **Pacific Ocean** (west) and **Atlantic Ocean** (east).

6. ISRO – National Space Day & Bharatiya Antariksh Station

National Space Day was observed on **23 August**, theme: '**Viksit Bharat**'. ISRO Chairman **V. Narayanan** addressed a press conference on upcoming missions.

- The **International Space Station (ISS)**, built in 1998 with US/Russia/France/China/others, will be retired around **2031**; several countries are now building their own stations.
- India's roadmap: **Gaganyaan** (first manned mission) – targeted for **2027**; **Chandrayaan-4** and **Chandrayaan-5** (with Japanese and Swedish collaboration); **Bharatiya Antariksh Station** (India's own space station) – targeted for completion by **2035**; first Indian Moon landing (crewed) targeted for **2040**.
- Space station specs: placed in **Low Earth Orbit (~400 km)**; capacity up to 5–6 astronauts (average 3); weight **~52 tonnes**; astronauts can stay up to **6 months**; investment of about **Rs. 1,763 crore**.

ISRO Quick Recap

- Father of the Indian Space Programme: **Vikram Sarabhai**. First Indian satellite: **Aryabhata**.
- First country to reach Mars orbit in its first attempt: India, via the **Mars Orbiter Mission (MOM)**, **2013** ('Mangalyaan').
- Mission that landed near the Moon's South Pole: **Chandrayaan-3**. India's first dedicated solar mission: **Aditya-L1**.
- The Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (**PSLV**) is known as ISRO's 'workhorse'.

7. India–Mauritius Oil Supply Agreement

A **5-year Government-to-Government (G2G)** oil supply agreement has been signed between India and Mauritius, announced by Union Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas **Hardeep Singh Puri**.

- Indian company involved: **Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL)** – a Maharatna company, headquartered in **Delhi**, established in **1959**.
- Under the deal, India will export oil/petroleum products to Mauritius (stored at capital **Port Louis**); agreement signed on **20 August**.
- Mauritius PM: **Navin Ramgoolam**. Mauritius, located in the Indian Ocean, is home to a large Indian diaspora and the official language there includes **Bhojpuri**; it also hosts the **World Hindi Secretariat**.
- India aims to hold **309 million tonnes** crude oil capacity by **2032** (India has the world's 4th-largest oil reserves).
- Related body – **OPEC**: organisation of oil-producing countries; formed in **1960**, headquartered in **Vienna** (Austria); originally founded discussions in Baghdad; **UAE** has exited the grouping; currently has 11 member countries.

8. India–Russia Relations & North Korea Missile to Russia

- The **27th session** of the India–Russia Inter-Governmental Commission was held in **Moscow**; India was represented by External Affairs Minister **Dr S. Jaishankar**. Discussions covered science, technology, cyber security and terrorism.
- India–Russia joint military exercise: '**INDRA**' (first held in the year **2000**).
- **North Korea** has supplied Russia with a new missile, **KN-30**: speed of Mach 5–6, range **600–900 km**, uses a solid-fuel engine.

9. Sports – Diamond League & Chess

Diamond League 2026, Lausanne (Switzerland) – Javelin Throw

- 1st: **Rumesh (Sri Lanka)** – throw of **88.14 m** (also won gold at the recent Commonwealth Games).
- 2nd: **Neeraj Chopra (India)** – throw of **88.05 m** (silver); Neeraj's only Olympic gold came at Tokyo 2020, with silver at Paris 2024.
- World Javelin Throw Day was observed on **7 August**.

Kanizsa Open 2026, Hungary (Chess)

- Winner: **Praneeth M.** (nicknamed the 'Golden Boy'), a 19-year-old Grandmaster from **Tamil Nadu**; defeated a German opponent in the final.
- Hungary's capital: **Budapest**.

10. Miss Universe India 2026

Kaziya Ilyas, a law student from **Kerala**, has been crowned **Miss Universe India 2026**. She will represent India at the **75th Miss Universe** pageant to be held in Mexico.

11. Quick Revision Round-Up

- Two vessels hijacked off **Yemen–Somalia** waters, carrying 22 Indians, have now been handed over/released.
- **Qeshm Island** (Iran) is known for its green mangrove forests.
- **Rs. 62,500 crore** allocated under the mobile phone manufacturing incentive scheme.
- Third anti-submarine warfare shallow-water craft '**Mangrol**' launched at Kochi.
- **Sophie Adenot** – first French woman to conduct a spacewalk.
- A newly discovered exoplanet, much larger than other planets, has been termed a '**Mega Earth**'.
- **Madras Day** observed on **22 August**.
- **Commonwealth Cue Sports Championship** to be held in **Ahmedabad** in October.
- Indian pair **Treesa (Trisha) and Gayatri** won a bronze medal at the **BWF World Badminton Championships**.

12. Practice MCQs – From Today's Current Affairs

Q1. In which country was the first case of H5N1 (Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza) confirmed in a mammal?

- India
- Australia

- (c) Indonesia
- (d) New Zealand

Ans: (b) Australia – in a Long-nosed Fur Seal, South Australia.

Q2. What is the capital of South Australia?

- (a) Canberra
- (b) Sydney
- (c) Adelaide
- (d) Perth

Ans: (c) Adelaide.

Q3. Which Tamil Nadu scheme provides free LPG cylinders through reimbursement (DBT)?

- (a) Ujjwala Yojana
- (b) Annapoorna Super Six
- (c) Sathru Payanam
- (d) PM Garib Kalyan

Ans: (b) Annapoorna Super Six.

Q4. The Nehru Trophy Boat Race (72nd edition) is held on which lake?

- (a) Vembanad Lake
- (b) Punnamada Lake
- (c) Ashtamudi Lake
- (d) Pulicat Lake

Ans: (b) Punnamada Lake, Alappuzha, Kerala.

Q5. The Indian Army's new drone battalion 'Baaz' has been raised from which city?

- (a) Amritsar
- (b) Jalandhar
- (c) Ludhiana
- (d) Pathankot

Ans: (b) Jalandhar, Punjab.

Q6. Where are the AK-203 'Sher' rifles being manufactured?

- (a) Ichapore Ordnance Factory
- (b) Korwa Ordnance Factory, Amethi
- (c) Tiruchirappalli Ordnance Factory
- (d) Kanpur Ordnance Factory

Ans: (b) Korwa Ordnance Factory, Amethi, UP.

Q7. Which US state has announced 8 November 2026 as 'Diwali Day'?

- (a) New York
- (b) Texas
- (c) California
- (d) New Jersey

Ans: (c) California.

Q8. Diwali was added as India's 16th entry to which UNESCO list, linked to which city?

- (a) World Heritage List – Delhi
- (b) Intangible Cultural Heritage List – Varanasi
- (c) Creative Cities Network – Jaipur
- (d) Memory of the World – Ayodhya

Ans: (b) Intangible Cultural Heritage List, Varanasi.

Q9. As per ISRO's roadmap, by which year is the Bharatiya Antariksh Station targeted for completion?

- (a) 2030
- (b) 2032
- (c) 2035
- (d) 2040

Ans: (c) 2035.

Q10. Who is the current Chairman of ISRO?

- (a) S. Somanath
- (b) K. Sivan
- (c) V. Narayanan
- (d) A.S. Kiran Kumar

Ans: (c) V. Narayanan.

Q11. Which Indian company signed the 5-year G2G oil supply agreement with Mauritius?

- (a) ONGC
- (b) Indian Oil Corporation Limited (IOCL)
- (c) Bharat Petroleum
- (d) Hindustan Petroleum

Ans: (b) IOCL.

Q12. Who is the Union Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas who announced the India–Mauritius oil deal?

- (a) Piyush Goyal
- (b) Hardeep Singh Puri
- (c) S. Jaishankar
- (d) Nirmala Sitharaman

Ans: (b) Hardeep Singh Puri.

Q13. OPEC was formed in which year and is headquartered where?

- (a) 1960, Vienna
- (b) 1965, Geneva
- (c) 1970, Baghdad

(d) 1955, Paris

Ans: (a) 1960; Headquarters: Vienna, Austria.

Q14. The 27th session of the India–Russia Inter-Governmental Commission was held in which city?

- (a) St. Petersburg
- (b) Moscow
- (c) New Delhi
- (d) Sochi

Ans: (b) Moscow.

Q15. The KN-30 missile, recently supplied to Russia, originated from which country?

- (a) Iran
- (b) China
- (c) North Korea
- (d) Belarus

Ans: (c) North Korea.

Q16. Who won gold in Javelin Throw at the Lausanne Diamond League 2026?

- (a) Neeraj Chopra (India)
- (b) Anderson Peters
- (c) Rumesh (Sri Lanka)
- (d) Jakub Vadlejch

Ans: (c) Rumesh (Sri Lanka), throw of 88.14 m.

Q17. Neeraj Chopra secured which position at the Lausanne Diamond League 2026?

- (a) 1st (Gold)
- (b) 2nd (Silver)
- (c) 3rd (Bronze)
- (d) Did not qualify

Ans: (b) 2nd (Silver), throw of 88.05 m.

Q18. Who won the Kanizsa Open 2026 chess title held in Hungary?

- (a) D. Gukesh
- (b) R. Praggnanandhaa
- (c) Praneeth M.
- (d) Arjun Erigaisi

Ans: (c) Praneeth M., a Grandmaster from Tamil Nadu.

Q19. Kaziya Iliyas, crowned Miss Universe India 2026, belongs to which state?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Kerala
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Andhra Pradesh

Ans: (b) Kerala.

Q20. 'Madras Day' is observed on which date?

- (a) 20 August
- (b) 21 August
- (c) 22 August
- (d) 23 August

Ans: (c) 22 August.